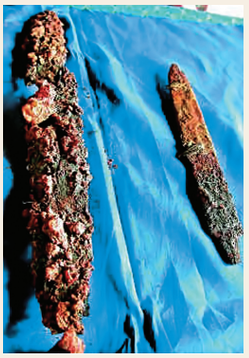


Black and Red ware in Adhichanallur.





(a) Iron sword and dagger in Adhichanallur
(b) Bronze vessel from a Burial at Auroville, Puducherry

Iron Technology and Metal Tools

The megalithic burials have abundant iron objects placed in the burials as grave goods. Weapons such as swords and daggers, axes, chisels, lamps and tripod stands are also found. Some of these objects were hafted to wooden or bone or horn handles and used. The iron tools were used for agriculture, hunting, gathering and in battles. Bronze bowls, vessels with stylish finials decorated with animals and birds, bronze mirrors and bells have also been found.

Recap

- The history of humans is intimately linked with the history of the earth. The earth originated around 4.54 billion years ago.
- The ancestors of human called hominins appeared about 5–7 million years ago.
- Although people gave divine explanations for the origin of humans, science believes in the theory of human evolution from the great apes.
- Humans began to domesticate animals and cultivate crops. The agricultural revolution led to many changes. Humans lived in permanent houses, made pottery and with the surplus production, they developed various crafts.
- The earliest evidence of humans is available in Tamil Nadu around 2-1.5 million years ago.
- The Middle Paleolithic Culture is found in some parts of Tamil Nadu.
- The Mesolithic people lived in all the areas of Tamil Nadu.
- Neolithic culture is limited to northwestern part of Tamil Nadu.
- The Iron Age saw further expansion of people in various cultural zones. The foundation of subsequent Sangam Age was laid during this age.
- Iron tools were used in agriculture.

EXERCISE

CJ5IA

I. Choose the correct answer

1. _____ is genetically closest to humans

(a) Gorilla (b) Chimpanzee

(c) Orang-utan (d) Great Apes

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